

Inside a computer

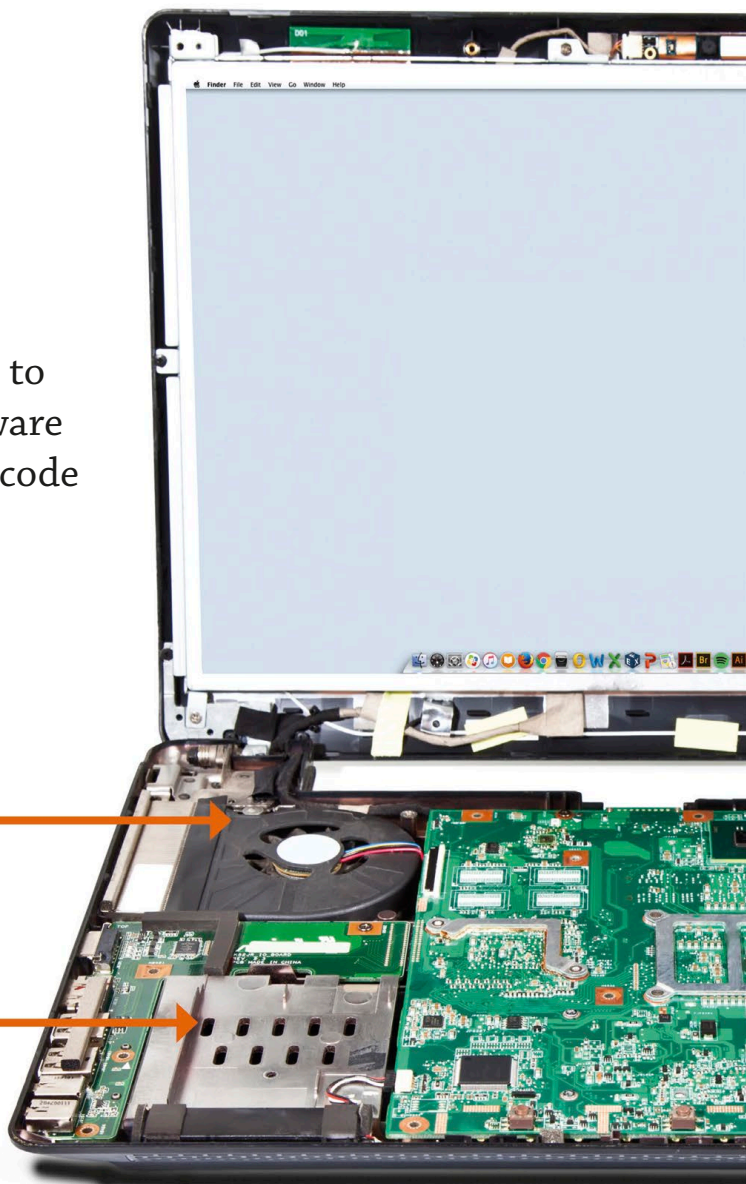
The physical parts of a computer are called hardware. Coders need to understand how computer hardware works so that they can write the code that tells computers what to do.

Hard drive

This is where most of the computer's data is stored.

RAM

Random Access Memory is short-term memory that stores information only when the power is on.



Storage

Computer data needs to be saved so that it can be shared and used again. This is done using storage. Today, we save data using “clouds,” a form of Internet storage. Here are some physical storage devices, some of which we still use.



Punched tape

Early computers in the 1950s and 60s stored data as holes on punched tape.



Floppy disk

From the 1970s, data was stored on thin disks protected by plastic covers.